

Univ.-Prof. Dr.-Ing. Matthias Wessling

Personal data

Name	Univ.-Prof. Dr.-Ing. Matthias Wessling
Address	Aachener Verfahrenstechnik, RWTH Aachen, DWI - Leibniz Institute for Interactive Materials, Forckenbeckstr. 51, 52074 Aachen, Germany
Date of Birth	10th March, 1963
Place of Birth	Ahaus, Germany
Nationality	German
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Current Position

Full Professor and Alexander-von-Humboldt Professor of Chemical Process Engineering

Academic Qualifications

1989 – 1993	Dr.-Ing., University of Twente, Enschede, The Netherlands Thesis: Relaxation phenomena in Dense Gas Separation Membranes
1983 – 1989	Dipl.-Ing. Chemietechnik, University of Dortmund, Germany Thesis: Separation of aromatic C8-Isomers by pervaporation, external at the University of Cincinnati

Professional Career

since 2024	Vice-Rector for Transfer, RWTH Aachen University, Germany
2018 – 2024	Vice-Rector for Research and Structure, RWTH Aachen University, Germany
since 2011	Member of the Scientific Board of DWI - Leibniz Institute for Interactive Materials, Aachen, Germany
since 2010	Chair Chemical Process Engineering (W3), RWTH Aachen University, Germany
2015 – 2018	Vice Dean of the Faculty of Mechanical Engineering at RWTH Aachen University, Germany
2015 – 2018	Vice Scientific Director of the Leibniz Institute for Interactive Materials
2010 – 2020	Adjunct Professor, University of Twente, Enschede, The Netherlands
2007 – 2008	Dean, Faculty of Science and Technology, University of Twente, Enschede, The Netherlands
2006 – 2009	Department Head, Chemical Engineering, University of Twente, Enschede, The Netherlands
1999 – 2010	Chair and Full Professor, Membrane Science and Technology, Faculty of Science and Technology, University of Twente, Enschede, The Netherlands
1997 – 1999	Department Head, Separation Processes, Akzo Nobel Chemicals Research, Arnhem, The Netherlands
1994 – 1997	Assistant Professor, University of Twente, Enschede, The Netherlands
1993 – 1994	Senior Research Scientist, MTR Inc., Menlo Park, CA, USA

Honours and Awards

2022	Elected Member of the German National Academy of Sciences Leopoldina
2020	Selby Fellow of the Australian Academy of Science
2019	Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz Prize of the German Research Foundation DFG
2016	ERC Advanced Grant, ConFluReM Controlling Fluid Resistances at Membranes
2010	Alexander-von-Humboldt Professor, RWTH Aachen University, Germany
2003	Scientific Honorary Member of the Topchiev Institute of Petrochemical Sciences, Moscow, Russia
1994	Best Ph.D. Award, European Membrane Society

Other Professional Activities

2025	Evaluation board for the Volkswagen Stiftung, Excellence Initiative Lower Saxony
since 2020	Member of the Supervisory Board of the University of Twente
since 2020	Member of the Scientific Advisory Board of the Max-Planck Institute for Complex Technical Systems, Magdeburg
since 2019	Scientific Advisory Board of the Leibniz Institute for Polymer Research, IFP, Dresden
since 2000	Member of the DECHEMA Working Party "Membrane Technology"
2020 – 2025	Review board member of the DFG Section 401-403 Chemical and Thermal Process Engineering, reelected in 2024
2006 – 2019	Editor Journal of Membrane Science
2013 – 2018	Vice-Speaker RWTH Aachen University Profile Area "Energy, Chemical & Process Engineering – ECPE"
2011 – 2018	Steering Board Member of DFG Cluster of Excellence "Tailor-Made Fuels from Biomass", RWTH Aachen University, Germany
2007 – 2018	Vice-Speaker of Collaborative Research Centre (SFB) 985: "Functional microgels and systems"
2011 – 2014	Speaker Aachener Verfahrenstechnik, RWTH Aachen University, Germany
2010 – 2015	Scientific advisory board BIGCCS International CCS Research Center, Norway
2003 – 2012	Editorial Board "Separation and Purification Technology"
2007 and 2014	Visiting professor, Stanford University, USA
2006 – 2009	Board member Dutch Science Foundation NWO Working Party "Macromolecules"
2007 – 2009	Board member Dutch National Research School "Process Technology"
2004	Co-Founder "Center of Excellence for Sustainable Water Technology", Wetsus, Leeuwarden, The Netherlands
2003	Co-Founder of the European Network of Excellence "NanoMemPro"
2003 – 2006	Member of the Technical Advisory Board GKSS, Helmholtz Institute, Geesthacht, Germany
1998 – 2002	Board member of the European Membrane Society

Spin-outs and Startup Support

2003	NANOMI Develops nano and micrometer-sized membranes and devices for liquid/liquid droplet formation
2003	MOSAIC SYSTEMS Developed mixed matrix membranes for membrane chromatography applications (Founder and CTO)
2003	LIGHTMOTIF Designs and develops surface structured materials by laser ablation processes and subsequent surface modification
2003	CON-VERGENCE Develops fluid handling systems for membrane filtration
2020	FURTHERMIND, Research Data Management
2023	FXC Engineering GmbH Develops electrochemical cells
2023	BIOTHRUST Bionic bioreactors for bubble-free fermentation and cell production
2024	AMOVION Flow capacitive deionization
2025	NAION.TECH Nanofiltration membranes and processes

Scientific Career Support

Prof.dr.ir. Nico van der Vegt – TU Darmstadt – Theoretical physical chemistry

Prof.dr.ir. Rob Lammertink – University of Twente – Soft Matter Fluidics and Interfaces

Prof.dr.ir. Nieck Benes – University of Twente – Thin films in fluids

Prof.dr.ir. Dimitrios Stamatialis - Universität Twente – Biomedical Membrane Applications

Prof.dr.ir. Saiful, Universitas Syiah Kuala - Analytical Chemistry

Prof.dr.ir. Kitty Nijmeier – Technical University of Eindhoven – Membrane Technology

Prof.Dr. Zeynep Culfaz, METU Ankara – Membrane Science – Associate Professor

Prof.dr.ir. Tao He, Shanghai Advanced Research Institute – Membrane technology

Dr.-Ing. Tao Luo, Sichuan University – Electrodialysis – Assist. Prof.

Dr. Youri Gendel, Technion Haifa – Electrochemical water treatment processes – Assist. Prof.

Dr. Oded Nir, Ben Gurion, Bersheba – Desalination processes – Assist. Prof

Prof. Dr.-Ing. John Linkhorst, Technical University of Darmstadt - Electrochemical process engineering – Assist. Prof.

Prof. Dr.-Ing. Hanna Roth, University of Duisburg Essen – Chemical Engineering – Full Prof.

Publication Record - Scopus, Nov. 2025

H-Index	95
Reviewed papers	748 (date Nov. 2025)
Patents	38 (Google Patents)
Proceedings	12 (Aachen Membrane Kolloquium, Aachener Tagung Wassertechnology)

March 9, 2026